

RG 158 SPORTS BAR & ENTERTAINMENT · SARALAND, ALABAMA

The Booking Operations Manual.

A working reference for the team handling comedy bookings — every agency contact, every incentive lever, every counter-leverage script needed to close a deal at the right number.

DIRECTORY · PLAYBOOK · CHECKLIST

Companion to the v3 Investor Brief. Use this for daily booking workflow.

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1 · Master Booking Agency Directory

Organized by tier (size of roster + reachability), with specific contacts for each comedian on the RG 158 shortlist.

1.1 · Tier 1 — Major agencies (formal pitch — slow but high quality)

Process takes 2–6 weeks. Email a specific agent, not a general inquiry box. Address agents by name — assistants screen and a nameless email gets binned.

Agency	Office	Phone	Comedy contacts	Roster relevance
WME (William Morris Endeavor)	9601 Wilshire Blvd, Beverly Hills CA 90210 NY: 11 Madison Ave, NY 10010 Nashville: 1201 Demonbreun St	(310) 285-9000 (212) 586-5100 (615) 963-3000	Mike Berkowitz (Head of Comedy Touring) Marc Gerald · Sam Moradzadeh · Ari Lubet Nashville country: Jay Williams, Chris Pierce, Brian Hill	Phil Hanley, Mark Normand (touring), mid-tier country acts
CAA (Creative Artists Agency)	2000 Ave of the Stars, LA CA 90067 Nashville: 401 Commerce St #700	(424) 288-2000 (615) 383-8787	Matt Blake (Head of Comedy Touring) Christian Carino · Mike Berman · Hunter Hill Nashville country: Darin Murphy (Parmalee) , Marc Dennis, Kevin Neal, Brian Manning	Parmalee, Walker Hayes , several Tier A comedy
UTA (United Talent Agency)	9336 Civic Center Dr, Beverly Hills Nashville: 819 18th Ave S	(310) 273-6700 (615) 297-0100	Nick Nuciforo (Head) David Anderson · Jolyon Rubinstein	Several Tier A comedy names
Avalon Artists Group	9255 Sunset Blvd #1010, West Hollywood CA 90069	(323) 692-1700 NY: (212) 868-3200	Tom Sharpe (heavy comedy roster) Jamie Masada (Comedy Store, related)	Lace Larrabee, Karlous Miller (some), Chico Bean

Email format: typically `firstname.lastname@wmeagency.com` , `@caa.com` , `@unitedtalent.com` . Verify each.

1.2 · Tier 2 — Mid-major agencies (your daily phone contacts)

Smaller rosters, clearer routing, faster reply times (3–7 days). You'll work with these agencies 80% of the time.

Agency	Web · Phone	Specialty	Roster relevance
MN2S	mn2s.com US: (212) 729-2188 UK HQ: +44 (0) 207 928 9988	Global comedy, mid-major	Tom Segura, Bert Kreischer, Dusty Slay — use roster page contact form on each comic's profile
A to Z Entertainment	atozentertainment.com (888) 655-4575	Clean / corporate / Christian / Southern / family	Henry Cho, several clean Tier A/B
The Grable Group	thegrablegroup.com (615) 283-0039 (Nashville)	Clean comedy, Christian, family-corporate	Dustin Nickerson , John Crist, Henry Cho
Funny Business Agency	funny-business.com (231) 933-7575 (Traverse City MI)	Midwest, clean, college, corporate	Mark Gross, Mark Chalifoux, multiple Tier B
Central Talent Booking (CTB)	centraltalentbooking.com	Touring comedy, club circuit	Dusty Slay (alt route) . Ask for: Jackie Knobbe, Andrew Lambrose, Nick Ngo
Headline Entertainment	headlineentertainment.us	Southern / blue-collar	Multiple Southern Tier B/C, country crossover
Sound Talent Group	soundtalentgroup.com	Newer, music + comedy, growing	Mid-tier touring on the rise
Authentic Talent & Literary Mgmt	authentictalent.com (323) 658-7600	Black comedy, urban-rooted, podcast	Tony Baker , Mike Epps, Eddie Griffin, several Mobile-target names
3 Arts Entertainment	3arts.com (310) 888-3200	Larger management firm (TV/film/comedy)	Various Tier A names, JFL alums

1.3 · Tier 3 — Direct-to-comic / management routes

Many mid-tier comics have outgrown their first agency or never had one. Direct contact is faster and cleaner.

Comedian	Direct route	Backup route
Heath Hyché	heathhyche.com contact form	DM @heathhyche on IG
Aaron Weber	aaronwebercomedy.com / Nateland Entertainment	MN2S Nashville-circle
Dusty Slay	MN2S roster page	Central Talent Booking
Phil Hanley	philhanley.com → WME	DM @philhanley on IG
Tony Baker	Authentic Talent	DM @realtonybaker
Killer Beaz	killerbeaz.com contact form	A to Z Entertainment · Opry artist services
Trae Crowder	traecrowdertour.com	WellRED Comedy management (wellredcomedy.com)
Drew Morgan + Corey Ryan Forrester	wellredcomedy.com	Trae Crowder shared management
Lace Larrabee	lancelarrabee.com	Avalon Artists Group
Karlous Miller	85 South Show management	Authentic Talent · major agency (verify current)
Dustin Nickerson	The Grable Group	Direct via dustinnickerson.com
Mark Chalifoux	Funny Business Agency	Direct via markchalifoux.com
Adam Minnick	Direct via adamminnick.com	Dry Bar Comedy roster
Ryan Hamilton	ryanhamiltoncomedy.com → WME likely	Direct-to-website inquiry
Mary Mack	marymackcomedy.com	Funny Business Agency
Henry Cho	henrychocomedy.com	A to Z Entertainment · Grable Group

1.4 · Country music agency contacts (April 2027 festival)

Start the festival booking conversation NOW even though the event is 11 months out. Country quotes climb 30–50% YoY in 2026.

Artist	Agency	Specific contact
Parmalee ★ ANCHOR	CAA Nashville (NOT BBR — BBR is the label)	Darin Murphy · (615) 383-8787 — verify current agent
Walker Hayes	WME Nashville	Jay Williams team · (615) 963-3000
Mitchell Tenpenny	Riser House / CAA Nashville	Verify per recent label/agency moves
Drew Baldridge	Independent / direct + management	drewbaldridge.com → management
Wyatt Flores ★ LOCK QUOTE THIS WEEK	Monaterra Music Group	wyattflores.com → management listed
Jackson Dean	CAA Nashville	(615) 383-8787
Tyler Braden	WME Nashville	(615) 963-3000
Niko Moon	CAA / verify	bookingagentinfo.com
Tigirlily Gold	Independent / verify	tigirlilygold.com
Conner Smith	WME Nashville	(615) 963-3000
Filmore	Independent / direct	filmoreofficial.com
Restless Road	CAA Nashville	(615) 383-8787
Chayce Beckham	WME (post-Idol)	(615) 963-3000
Dasha	Verify recent — viral momentum changed routing	dashaofficial.com

1.5 · Black-comedy specialty routing (Mobile-market reach)

Comedian	Agency	Contact
Tony Baker	Authentic Talent	authentictalent.com
Karlous Miller	Major (verify — likely CAA or 3 Arts)	85 South Show management
Chico Bean	Avalon Artists Group	avalonusa.com
DC Young Fly	CAA	bookingagentinfo.com
Lavell Crawford	Authentic / direct	lavellcomedy.com
Kountry Wayne	WME / Mosaic	kountrywayne.com → management listed
Nate Jackson	Direct via Super Funny Comedy Club Tacoma	natejacksoncomedy.com
Mike Epps	Authentic Talent	authentictalent.com
Eddie Griffin	Authentic / direct	eddiegriffin.com

1.6 · Local circuit (Tier C openers + emergency swing)

- **Compton Smith** (Mobile-area comic, network gatekeeper) — search his social for direct contact
- **Smokey Jokes Comedy Club Mobile** — local talent network for openers
- **Stingers Comedy Club Pensacola** — open mic + opener pipeline
- **StarDome Comedy Club Birmingham** — mid-tier touring routing reference
- **Crescent Theater Mobile** — direct comp venue (book opposite weekends)
- **Pensacola Indie Fringe** — alt-circuit talent

2 · Negotiation Playbook

Convert non-cash assets into perceived value to the comedian — pay 70% of their corporate quote and have them say yes happily.

2.1 · What RG 158 has that other 200-cap rooms don't

Lead every conversation by referencing at least 2 of these moats:

1. **Two on-site bars** (main + upstairs VIP) — most 200-cap rooms have one. Real upper-tier VIP product, not theater.
2. **Concert-grade PA + programmable stage lighting** — comedians shooting specials from your room get clean audio.
3. **J Rodgers BBQ on-site** — 30+ years, 4.3 stars. \$150 perceived value at \$50 actual cost.
4. **Lockable upstairs VIP greenroom** — most clubs have a curtained-off broom closet.
5. **15 minutes from Mobile, 60-min radius covers 400K adults** — bigger draw radius than most equivalent-metro comedy rooms.
6. **Sister business cross-promo (J Rodgers BBQ)** — built-in 30-year customer list.
7. **Festival comedy slot reservation right** — UNIQUE to RG 158. No other 200-cap club can offer "do well here, get a paid 30-min slot at our 10K-attendee festival in April 2027."
8. **Owner-operator buy-in** — agents prefer dealing directly with the owner.
9. **Already-built rg158ent.com with Square checkout** — agents check the site. 80% of small venues fail this test.
10. **No radius-clause conflicts** — no other 200-cap comedy room within 60 miles.

2.2 · Incentive levers — convert non-cash assets to fee discounts

Lever	Cash cost	Perceived value	Best used when
Hampton Saraland hotel partnership	\$0–\$95/night	\$150–\$200	Always — table stakes
Ground transport (party bus, limo, Uber)	\$50–\$200	\$200–\$400	Tier B and up
J Rodgers BBQ private dinner	\$40–\$80	\$150–\$250	Always — your unique signature
\$60 buyout per principal (2026 standard)	\$60–\$240	\$60–\$240	Always — non-negotiable price floor
Comp tickets for crew + family (5–10)	\$0	\$300–\$700	Tier B and up
60-second vertical post-show clip (rights kept by comic)	\$0–\$200	\$1,500+ (one viral clip = tens of thousands)	EVERY comic — non-negotiable for you
Festival comedy slot booking right (April 2027)	\$0 today	\$5,000–\$15,000 future booking	Tier A and B — UNIQUE LEVER
Routing-detour kicker (\$500 travel stipend)	\$500	\$500 cash + closes routing gap	Comics already in region
Repeat-booking discount (10% off second if first ≥80%)	\$500–\$2K future	\$500–\$2K future + relationship	Tier B you want to grow with
Merch rights — 100% to comic, no cut	\$0	\$500–\$3,000/show	Always — never take a merch split
J Rodgers BBQ cross-promo (30-yr customer list)	\$0	\$1,000+ marketing reach	Local-pride pitches (Heath, Dusty)
Country radio trade (WKSJ, WDLT, Magic 99.9)	\$0	\$2,000–\$5,000 perceived ad value	Country-leaning comics, hi-volume promoters
Saraland/Mobile media (Lagniappe, AL.com)	\$0	\$1,000–\$3,000 PR value	First-of-series headliners
Same-night cash settlement (or NET-7 max)	\$0	High trust signal	Always offer; many venues are NET-30

2.3 · Three deal-structure templates — pick by tier

Template A · Flat guarantee (Tier C / first-time comics)

"\$1,500 flat for one show, \$2,500 flat for two shows. Includes hotel, ground, \$60 buyout per principal, BBQ dinner, comp tickets for crew + 4 guests. Deposit 50% on signing, balance same night cash."

Template B · Versus deal (Tier B workhorses — DEFAULT)

"\$5,000 versus 70% of net door over \$7,500 — whichever is greater. Net door = ticket revenue minus Square fees, comps, holds. F&B stays 100% with venue. Settlement same night cash or NET-7 wire."

Template C · Door split + low guarantee (Tier A anchors only)

"\$10,000 + 80% of net door above \$20,000. F&B stays 100% with venue. Settlement same night cash. Deposit 50% on signing, balance pre-show day."

2.4 · Counter-leverage scripts — when agents push back

Agent says	Your reply
"What's your guarantee?"	"Open to flat, versus, or door split. Send me their standard quote and let's work backward from their draw on a 200-cap two-show." <i>(Never name a number first.)</i>
"What's your draw history?"	"RG 158 has hosted [list 2–3 prior events]. Series launches July 2026 — debut headliner gets full marketing weight. \$800/show fixed Meta + 25K social reach + J Rodgers cross-promo + Mobile country radio trade."
Quote is too high	"That's outside the budget for a debut series booking. Can we look at a versus deal — pays them more on a sellout but gives us breakeven protection? Happy to show you the room economics."
Wants full guarantee at top of range	"Guarantee at [-25% of ask] plus 70% net door above breakeven — that's where the upside is."
Asks for radius clause > 50 mi	"Standard 50 mi / 60 days is fine — anything beyond that conflicts with our other bookings on the calendar."
Asks for all the door	Walk away. "That doesn't work for us — bar and F&B economics are how the venue stays in business."
Wants merch cut	Always offer 100% merch to comic. Never take a split. (#1 deal-breaker for comics if you do.)
Rider has private chef line	Counter: "\$60/principal buyout instead of catered greenroom." Don't negotiate the menu.
Settlement timing pushed to NET-30	"Same night cash or NET-7. NET-30 doesn't work for our books."
"Need flight + hotel for entourage of 5"	"\$60 buyout × 5, hotel for principal + 1, ground for the group, additional rooms at our partner rate (comic covers cost)."
Asks for 2-show fee bump (+\$1K)	Pre-budget +30% on Tier B for 2-show; if you only want 1 show, say so up front.
Quote re-opens 90 days out	Hold them to the original written quote, or walk. This is bad-faith.

2.5 · Hard lines — never negotiate these away

- **Bar / F&B revenue** — 100% stays with venue. Always.
- **Radius clauses > 60 days / 50 miles** — kills your ability to book similar comics.
- **NET-30 settlement** — your cash flow can't carry that.
- **All-door / no-guarantee venue split** — kills bar economics.
- **Cancellation without notice** — must include 60-day-out = full refund + venue marketing reimbursement; 30-day-out = 50% deposit forfeit; 14-day-out = 100% deposit forfeit.
- **No-recording-any-form clause** — you need the right to capture the 60-second vertical clip.
- **100% advance payment demand** — 50% deposit on signing is the industry max for any comic under \$50K fee.

2.6 · Hospitality rider standards — what to expect

- **Buyout (cash for meals):** \$60/person 2026 standard. Pay flat to side-step menu disputes.
- **Hotel:** Hilton/Marriott family preferred; one room per principal, queens for entourage.
- **Ground transport:** dressing-room-to-venue and venue-to-hotel; airport pickup if flying.
- **Greenroom:** water, light snacks, towels, mirror, lockable door, coffee/tea.
- **Tech:** SM58 or comparable, single-spot stage light, water at stool — comedians' tech is dead simple.

3 · Pre-Flight Checklist

Lock these before sending email #1. Each unchecked box is a future loss event.

3.1 · Insurance

- ☐ Confirm general-liability carrier covers stand-up comedy (some policies have entertainment exclusions)
- ☐ **Per-show event cancellation insurance** — Event Helper, K&K, Hub International — \$150–\$250/show
- ☐ Liquor-liability rider current
- ☐ Certificate of Insurance template ready (agents request before quoting)

3.2 · Legal / contracts

- ☐ Booking contract template via DocuSign — comedy-specific (Berger Goldstein, NathanTimmel.com, or industry standard)
- ☐ Cancellation language: 60 / 30 / 14-day-out tiers
- ☐ No-radius clauses > 60 days / 50 miles
- ☐ Same-night settlement clause OR NET-7 wire

3.3 · Operations

- ☐ **2-item-minimum POS workflow tested** — Square Terminal prompt + server training + door wristbands
- ☐ **Box-office process locked** — who scans tickets, tracks 2-item, handles will-call
- ☐ **Swing-comic on retainer** — 2 local Tier C, \$400 hold-fee + double-on-activation
- ☐ Greenroom prep checklist — water, towels, snacks, mirror, lock, coffee/tea

3.4 · Venue / hospitality

- ☐ Hampton Saraland (or partner) corporate rate signed in writing
- ☐ Ground transport vendors confirmed (party bus + Uber Business + limo backup)
- ☐ J Rodgers BBQ greenroom dinner SOP — same menu every time, \$50 cost target
- ☐ Hotel partner rate quoted in dollars, not negotiated per show

3.5 · Marketing / promotion

- ☐ Email-capture banner live on rg158ent.com homepage
- ☐ **NON-show email capture pipeline** — J Rodgers customer list import + festival waitlist + social contests
- ☐ Meta Business Manager set up + first \$200 audience-research test running
- ☐ WKSJ Kicker 94.9, WDLT 98.3, Magic 99.9/105.5 radio rep contacts confirmed
- ☐ **TikTok content workflow** — who shoots, who edits, who uploads within 48hr

3.6 · Festival critical path (parallel — don't wait for comedy series to "succeed first")

☐ **Saraland city manager meeting THIS WEEK**☐ Outdoor venue Plan A + Plan B scoped by end of June 2026☐ **Wyatt Flores quote-lock email THIS WEEK** to Monaterra Music Group☐ Parmalee CAA Nashville inquiry (Darin Murphy) — quote letter for April 2027 weekend headline 10K cap outdoor in Saraland AL☐ Sponsorship deck drafted — 3 tiers (\$5K / \$25K / \$100K) for Bud Light, Ford, Trustmark, J Rodgers, Coors, Tito's, Wrangler, Cabela's, Sirius Highway

3.7 · Financial

☐ QBO sub-account "Festival 2027" opened — every comedy net dollar tracked here☐ Square sub-location for ticketed shows separate from rental events☐ Per-show P&L template locked — ticket rev, F&B rev, talent, agent commission (12%), production, insurance, marketing, hospitality, staff, fees, net☐ **Snowball stress-test at 40% sellthrough** — does Show 2 still get funded? If no, lower Show 1 talent ceiling.

4 · Booking Pipeline Tracker (template)

Send all 8–11 priority emails within a 7-day window. Booking is a parallel pipeline, not a serial one. Multiple "yes"s let you pick best fit per slot; multiple "no"s just means you move to alternates faster.

Comedian	Tier	Date sent	Recipient (agent)	Status	Quote	Counter sent	Final terms
Heath Hyche	C			—			
Aaron Weber	B			—			
Phil Hanley	B			—			
Tony Baker	B/D			—			
Dusty Slay	B+			—			
Dustin Nickerson	B			—			
Lace Larrabee	B- Female			—			
Killer Beaz	A			—			
Drew Morgan + CRF (WellRED)	B-pair			—			
Karlous Miller	B/D			—			
Trae Crowder	A			—			

Status legend: sent · replied · quoted · negotiating · signed · declined

Festival booking tracker (start now)

Artist	Day	Date sent	Agent contact	Status	Quote	Notes
Parmalee (anchor)	Day 1		CAA Nashville · Darin Murphy	—		
Walker Hayes / Mitchell Tenpenny (anchor alt)	Day 2		WME Nashville / CAA Nashville	—		
Wyatt Flores (LOCK NOW)	Direct support		Monaterra Music Group	—		
Drew Baldridge	Direct support		Direct via drewbaldridge.com	—		
Jackson Dean	Direct support alt		CAA Nashville	—		
Tyler Braden	Direct support alt		WME Nashville	—		
Local opener Day 1	Local		Mobile/Saraland country band TBD	—		
Local opener Day 2	Local		Mobile/Saraland country band TBD	—		

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